

Hermes Ramp-Up

Learning & practicing a personal AI assistant (Nous Research's Hermes Agent)

LENGTH

~4 days (flexible)

RUNS ALONGSIDE

Docker / AWS / agent-loop
prep

PRACTICE FOCUS

Email + Calendar triage &
meeting summaries

Why this order: Day 1 gets Hermes installed and gives you a first real conversation, plus the "why it's powerful" framing up front so the rest clicks. Day 2 goes under the hood — memory, skills, MCP, security — the mechanics that make it more than a chatbot. Day 3 connects it to Email + Calendar and practices triage. Day 4 is the meeting-summary/workflow-automation payoff, plus an honest look at what to harden before trusting it with real work. Day 5 is an optional stretch day if you want to go further. Days are labeled generically — slot them in wherever they fit around your other prep.

Day 1 — Install & Get Oriented

Setup + why it matters

☐ **Install Hermes Agent** **SETUP**

Desktop installer, or CLI-only via `curl -fsSL https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/install.sh | bash` (Linux/macOS/WSL2). Then run `hermes setup --portal` — one OAuth covers a model plus the built-in web search/image/TTS/browser tools.

☐ **Work through the official Quickstart tutorial** **HANDS-ON**

Have your first real conversation with it and try the key features the tutorial points you to.

☐ **Read up on why Hermes is different from a normal chatbot** **WHY IT'S POWERFUL**

The closed learning loop (it writes reusable "skills" from experience and improves them over time), persistent memory across sessions, and a "runs anywhere" architecture (a \$5 VPS, Daytona, or Modal — not tied to your laptop). This is the core pitch; everything else is detail on top of it.

☐ **Skim the Learning Path doc** **READ**

Use it to figure out which docs matter most for your use case (personal productivity) vs. what to skip for now (e.g. RL training, batch research workflows).

Day 2 — Core Concepts: Memory, Skills, MCP

Understanding the mechanics

☐ Memory System READ

Three layers: skill memory, conversational memory (cross-session recall via FTS5 + LLM summarization), and Honcho-based user modeling. This is what lets it stop re-asking you the same context every session.

☐ Skills System READ

Procedural memory the agent writes for itself; compatible with the open agentskills.io standard, so skills are portable and shareable via the Skills Hub.

☐ MCP Integration READ

How Hermes connects to external MCP servers to gain new tools — this is the mechanism you'll use to hook up Gmail/Calendar on Day 3.

☐ Security & command approval READ

Understand command approval, authorization, and container isolation settings before you grant it access to your real inbox and calendar.

☐ Optional: write a SOUL.md HANDS-ON

Define a default personality/voice for Hermes — small thing, but it's a nice way to make the agent feel like "yours."

Day 3 — Connect Email + Calendar, Practice Triage

Hands-on, real accounts

☐ Connect Gmail HANDS-ON

Two paths: the built-in Google Workspace skill, or Composio Connect (CLI or MCP). Start with limited/read-only scopes until you trust the setup — Hermes can draft, send, and even delete emails once connected.

☐ Connect Google Calendar HANDS-ON

Same Composio Connect flow. You can bring your own OAuth credentials and configure exactly which scopes/actions are allowed.

☐ Practice: inbox triage HANDS-ON

Ask Hermes to categorize messages by urgency, draft replies for the routine ones, and flag anything that actually needs you. This is the single highest-leverage habit to build early.

☐ Set up a scheduled morning briefing HANDS-ON

Use Hermes' built-in cron to deliver a daily digest — yesterday's calendar plus an inbox summary — to wherever you'll actually see it (CLI, Telegram, email).

Day 4 — Meeting Summaries & Real Workflows

The payoff + a gut check

☐ Practice: meeting summaries **HANDS-ON**

Feed Hermes notes or a transcript from a real (or test) meeting and have it produce a structured summary with action items, owners, and deadlines.

☐ Try a chained workflow **HANDS-ON**

Turn an email into a calendar invite, or a meeting note into a follow-up draft email — this is where connecting multiple tools starts to feel like real leverage.

☐ Try delegation / subagents **HANDS-ON**

Spawn an isolated subagent for a parallel task (e.g. one triages email while another drafts a summary) to get a feel for how delegation works.

☐ Write a short readiness note **WRAP-UP**

What surprised you about why it's powerful, and a list of guardrails (scopes, approval settings) you'd want tightened before trusting it with anything work-sensitive at Link Ventures.

Day 5 — Stretch (Optional)

Go further if time allows

☐ Add another messaging platform **HANDS-ON**

Slack or Telegram, so you can reach Hermes from anywhere, not just the CLI.

☐ Try a serverless backend **HANDS-ON**

Run it on Daytona or Modal so it hibernates when idle and doesn't need to live on your laptop.

☐ Harden before real use **SETUP**

Revisit scopes and approval requirements now that you've seen it in action, tightening anything that felt too permissive during practice.

Resources

Official Hermes Agent docs plus practical use-case writeups, organized by day.

1. Getting started (Day 1)

- [Installation Guide](#) — Hermes Agent Docs
- [Quickstart Tutorial](#) — Hermes Agent Docs
- [Learning Path](#) — Hermes Agent Docs
- [NousResearch/hermes-agent](#) — GitHub repo

2. Why it's powerful (Days 1-2)

- [Memory System](#) — Hermes Agent Docs
- [Skills System](#) — Hermes Agent Docs
- [Architecture](#) — Hermes Agent Docs (how it works under the hood)
- [User Stories & Use Cases](#) — Hermes Agent Docs

3. MCP, integrations & security (Day 2-3)

- [MCP Integration](#) — Hermes Agent Docs
- [Google Workspace Skill \(Gmail, Calendar, Drive, Sheets & Docs\)](#) — Hermes Agent Docs
- [Integrate Gmail \(MCP\) with Hermes](#) — Composio
- [Integrate Google Calendar \(MCP\) with Hermes](#) — Composio
- [Security](#) — Hermes Agent Docs (command approval, container isolation)

4. Practice patterns: triage & meeting summaries (Day 3-4)

- [5 Real Use Cases for Hermes Agent in Organizations](#) — [Daily Digest](#), Triage, Multi-Agent
- [Hermes Agent Use Cases: 10 Real-World Applications](#) — Fastio
- [Tips & Best Practices](#) — Hermes Agent Docs
- [Tutorial: Team Telegram Assistant](#) — Hermes Agent Docs (good model for the Day 5 stretch)

Practice scenarios to try

Morning briefing

Scheduled cron job: pull today's calendar + overnight inbox, summarize into a short briefing delivered before you open your laptop.

Post-meeting follow-up

Feed it real meeting notes; have it produce a summary with action items/owners and draft the follow-up email to attendees.

Weekly planning digest

Every Monday: pull last week's calendar, check for anything still open in your inbox, and generate a short "what moved, what's stuck, priorities this week" doc.

Focused on Nous Research's open-source Hermes Agent (released Feb 2026, MIT license). Sourced from official docs at hermes-agent.nousresearch.com and current use-case writeups as of July 2026. Days are intentionally unpegged to calendar dates — slot them in around your Docker/AWS/agent-loop prep however fits.